

Sotheby's

LONDON

TREASURES

TREASURES



Sotheby's
EST.
1744

LONDON 7 DECEMBER 2021

Sotheby's
EST.
1744

7 DECEMBER 2021 L21307





This page
LOT 27

TREASURES

AUCTION IN LONDON
7 DECEMBER 2021
10.30 AM

34-35 New Bond Street
London, W1A 2AA
+44 (0)20 7293 5000
sothebys.com
FOLLOW US @SOTHEBYS
#SOTHEBYSTREASURES
WWW.SOTHEBYS.COM/TREASURES

ALL EXHIBITIONS FREE
AND OPEN TO THE PUBLIC

Friday 3 December
9 AM–4.30 PM

Saturday 4 December
12 NOON–5 PM

Sunday 5 December
12 NOON–5 PM

Monday 6 December
9 AM–4.30 PM

*Viewing times, subject to
current government guidelines*

Sotheby's EST.
1744

TO LEARN MORE ABOUT
THE PROPERTY IN THIS
SALE, PLEASE VISIT
[SOTHEBYS.COM/L21307](https://www.sothebys.com/L21307)



UNIQUE COLLECTIONS

Mario Tavella
*President, Sotheby's France,
Chairman, Sotheby's Europe*
+33 1 53 05 53 12

Christina Prescott-Walker
*Senior Vice President
Global Director,
Regional Art and Objects*
+1 212 606 7332

Henry House
*Senior Director
Head of Furniture & Decorative Arts*
+44 (0)20 7293 5486

David McDonald
*Senior Director
Furniture*
+44 (0)20 7293 5107

Harry Dalmeny
Chairman UK & Ireland
+44 (0)20 7293 5848

Wendy Philips
Senior Director, Tax & Heritage
+44 (0)20 7293 6184

Mari-Claudia Jimenez
*Senior Vice President
Chairman, Co-Worldwide Head of
Business Development*
+1 212 606 7537

Franka Haiderer
*Senior Director
Co-Worldwide Head of Business
Development*
+44 (0)20 7293 5688

Alexandra Duch
*Senior Vice President
Head of Department, Consignment
Management*
+1 212 894 1437

George North
*Director
Valuations & Sales Manager*
+44 (0)20 7293 5752

Shiona Fourie
*Deputy Director
Senior Project Manager*
+44 (0)20 7293 5470
shiona.fourie@sothebys.com

SPECIALISTS

Henry House
*Senior Director, Head of Furniture
& Decorative Arts, London*
+44 (0)20 7293 5486
henry.house@sothebys.com

Alexander Kader FSA
*Senior Director, Co-Worldwide Head of
European Sculpture & Works of Art*
+44 (0)20 7293 5493
alexander.kader@sothebys.com

Cynthia Harris
Director, Head of Decorative Arts, Silver
+44 (0)20 7293 5531
cynthia.harris@sothebys.com

Jonathan Hills
Director, Clocks
+44 (0)20 7293 5538
jonathan.hills@sothebys.com

João Magalhães
Director, Furniture
+44 (0)20 7293 5089 joao.
magalhaes@sothebys.com

David Macdonald
Senior Director, Furniture
+44 (0)20 7293 5107
david.macdonald@sothebys.com

Christopher Mason
Director, Sculpture & Works of Art
+44 (0)20 7293 6062
christopher.mason@sothebys.com

David Goldthorpe
*Senior Director, EMEA Head of Books
& Manuscripts*
+44 (0)20 7293 5303
david.goldthorpe@sothebys.com

Kristian Spofforth
Director, Head of Department, Jewellery
+44 (0)20 7293 5589
Kristian.Spofforth@sothebys.com

Gabriel Heaton
Director, Specialist Books & Manuscripts
+44 (0)20 7293 5670
gabriel.heaton@sothebys.com

Thomas Williams
Director, Furniture
+44 (0)20 7293 6211
thomas.williams@sothebys.com

Adèle Bourbonne
Cataloguer, Furniture
+44 (0)20 7293 6809
adele.bourbonne@sothebys.com

Shiona Fourie
*Deputy Director,
Senior Project Manager*
+44 (0)20 7293 5470
shiona.fourie@sothebys.com

ENQUIRIES

SALE NUMBER
L21307 "JOSÉPHINE"

BIDS DEPARTMENT
+44 (0)20 7293 5283
fax +44 (0)20 7293 6255
bids.london@sothebys.com

Telephone bid requests should
be received 24 hours prior
to the sale. This service is
offered for lots with a low estimate
of £3,000 and above.

SALE ADMINISTRATOR
Niamh Ryan
niamh.ryan@sothebys.com
+44 (0)20 7293 5185

POST SALE SERVICES
Charlotte Langridge
Credit Control & Debt Collection
FOR PAYMENT, DELIVERY
AND COLLECTION
+44 (0)20 7293 5220
FAX +44 (0)20 7293 5910
ukpostsaleservices@sothebys.com

Consultants:
Harry Charteris
John Culme

TO LEARN MORE ABOUT
THE PROPERTY IN THIS
SALE, PLEASE VISIT
[SOTHEBYS.COM/L21307](https://www.sothebys.com/L21307)



CONTENTS

3

AUCTION INFORMATION

5

SPECIALISTS AND AUCTION ENQUIRIES

10

TREASURES: LOTS 1–30

146

HOW TO BID

147

BUYING AT AUCTION

149

EXPLANATION OF SYMBOLS

150

VAT INFORMATION FOR BUYERS

151

CONDITIONS OF BUSINESS FOR BUYERS

154

ADDITIONAL TERMS & CONDITIONS FOR ONLINE
BIDDING
WAREHOUSE, STORAGE, COLLECTION
INFORMATION

155

AUTHENTICITY GUARANTEE
IMPORTANT NOTICES
GLOSSARY OF TERMS

TO LEARN MORE ABOUT
THE PROPERTY IN THIS
SALE, PLEASE VISIT
[SOTHEBYS.COM/L21307](https://www.sothebys.com/L21307)



TREASURES

LONDON
7 DECEMBER 2021
10:30 AM
LOTS 1-30

This page
LOT 20

1

THE 'PARKER' INTAGLIO



PROPERTY FROM A PRIVATE BRITISH COLLECTION, LOTS 1 – 15

ITALIAN, 16TH/ EARLY 17TH CENTURY

INTAGLIO WITH VENUS AND CUPID AT THE FORGE OF VENUS

banded agate within a pendant mount
intaglio: 35mm., 1³/₈in.
43mm., 1³/₄in. overall

PROVENANCE

By tradition Archbishop Matthew Parker (1504-1575);
by whom gifted to Queen Elizabeth I of England (1533-1603)
[as described by Albert Way, 'Notice of a Jeweled Ornament
presented to Queen Elizabeth by Matthew Parker, Archbishop
of Canterbury', *Archaeological Journal*, 19, 1862, pp. 145-158];
possibly acquired John Sharp, Archbishop of York (1645-1714);
thence by family descent
certainly by family descent to Thomas Barwick Lloyd Baker
(1807-1886);
thence by family descent to the present owners

EXHIBITED

London, Tudor Exhibition. 1889-1890;
London, Victoria and Albert Museum, on long term loan
(ref: LOAN:MET ANON.107-1968)

LITERATURE

A. Way, 'Notice of a Jeweled Ornament presented to Queen
Elizabeth by Matthew Parker, Archbishop of Canterbury',
Archaeological Journal, 19, 1862, pp. 145-158

RELATED LITERATURE

R. E. Raspe and W. Tassie, *A Descriptive Catalogue of a General
Collection of Ancient and Modern Engraved Gems Cameos as
well as Intaglios*, London, 1791; E.F. Bange, *Die Italienischen
Bronzen der renaissance und des barock. Reliefs und Plaketten*,
Berlin, 1922, vol.II; M. Henig and M. Vickers, *Cameos in Context:
The Benjamin Zucker Lectures*, 1990, Oxford, 1993; I. Weber,
*Geschnittene Steine des 18. bis 20. Jahrhunderts: Vergessene
Kostbarkeiten in der Staatlichen Münzsammlung München*,
Munich, 1995; H. Burns, M. Collareta and D. Gasparotto, *Valerio
Belli Vicentino (1468c-1546)*, Vicenza, 2000; V. Donati and
R. Casadio, *Bronzi e pietre dure nelle incisioni di Valerio Belli
vicentino*, Ferrara, 2004; J. Boardman, D. Scarisbrick, C. Wagner
and E. Zwierlein-Diehl, *The Marlborough Gems: Formerly at
Blenheim Palace*, Oxfordshire, Oxford, 2009; D. Scarisbrick, C.
Wagner and J. Boardman, *The Guy Ladrière collection*, London,
2015; D. Scarisbrick, C. Wagner and J. Boardman, *The Beverley
Collection of Gems at Alnwick Castle*, London, 2017

£ 10,000-20,000



This banded agate intaglio is close to a model published in Raspe-Tassie (1797, *op. cit.*, no. 6468) as Vulcan forging arrows for Venus and Cupid, and there ascribed to the celebrated Italian Renaissance engraver Valerio Belli, also known as Valerio Vicentino (circa 1468-1546). The Raspe-Tassie gem is catalogued as 'Jasper, or rather a Rock Chrystal [sic]' (*op. cit.*). The model is found in a rock crystal panel on Belli's vase from the collection of Baron Maurice de Rothschild in the musée du Louvre (inv. no. OA 8281). It has been tentatively attributed to Belli by Burns, Collareta and Gasparotto (1494-1553) (*op. cit.*, pp. 263-264, 526, no. 182). The model is known, along with variants, in a series plaquettes, several of which are published by Bange (1922, *op. cit.*, nos. 900-901). Burns et al suggest that the model as seen in these plaquettes may be a later elaboration by Giovanni Bernardi (1494-1553) (*op. cit.*, pp. 263-264, 526, no. 182)

In Greek mythology Venus, or Aphrodite, was the wife of Vulcan, god of fire and the forge. In Virgil's *Aeneid* the goddess of beauty seduces Vulcan in order to persuade him to make Aeneas' elaborate armour, including the shield which was engraved with prophetic scenes depicting the future of Rome. The scene is represented in ancient Roman glyptics, such as the Syrian garnet cabochon intaglio in the Walters Art Museum, in which Vulcan is depicted seated at his anvil (the standard iconography for the god in glyptic art) with Venus seated before him (inv. no. 42.474). Raspe-Tassie lists several further depictions of Vulcan including another given to Belli (no. 6460), and a carnelian from the Palatine Cabinet which was in the collection of the Duc d'Orléans at the time of publication (1791) and, like the present gem, shows Venus standing (no. 6466). Note also the impression of a (presumably Neoclassical) gem with a similar scene to the present intaglio formerly in collection of Prince Poniatowski.

The present intaglio departs from the Raspe-Tassie model principally in the positioning of the anvil (and idiosyncratic tree stump with knots); the inclusion of Cupid's torch; and Venus' outstretched arm holding Cupid's bow and quiver (in the Raspe-Tassie model the arm is bent and the attributes absent). The present intaglio exhibits an erotic aspect absent in the Raspe-Tassie model, principally through the removal of the drape preserving Venus' modesty, which reveals her gender.

The gem is exceptional for the beauty of the stone. The engraver has ingeniously employed the red layers of agate to simulate the searing heat of the forge, which rises and evaporates as it reaches the gods' upper bodies. Although Belli is famed for his work of rock crystal, of which the Medici casket in Palazzo Pitti is his masterpiece, the engraver is known to have worked in hardstone. The beautiful diaspro marrone screziato intaglio with a muse, perhaps, Euterpe, in the collections of the Duke of Devonshire at Chatsworth, is an example of his use of a rare multi-coloured specimen hardstone (inv. no. 39/246; see Burns et al, *op. cit.*, no. 131). However, Belli's treatment of the Vulcan scene in the Rothschild vase differs from the present intaglio principally in the stocky figures which are tightly packed together. The present intaglio is characterised by more slender elegant figures and a greater sense of space, indicating that it post dates Belli's lifetime.

The quality of the engraving and the use of Belli's model points to a dating towards the close of the 16th century. However, the use of such a rare and unusual banded agate is more typical of the interest in specimen hardstones in the early 17th century, a time when European princes such as Rudolf II were forming *wunderkammern* (wonder rooms). The way in which the stone is obliquely carved, requiring the viewer to rotate the stone in order to read the scene, is also an approach seen in the 17th century (Diana Scarisbrick, private correspondence). The

dating of Renaissance glyptics is complex. Whilst the present intaglio is stylistically likely to date to the second half of the 16th century, a 17th century dating cannot be ruled out.

THE VULCAN INTAGLIO AND ITS ASSOCIATION WITH ARCHBISHOP PARKER

The gem was published as the 'Parker Jewel' by Albert Way in 1862. Way associated it with the set of nine conjoined vellum roundels, which record a gift by Archbishop Parker to Queen Elizabeth I (also Lloyd Baker collection, see lots 2 and 3). Way describes the gem as a convex 'jasper agate' and describes it as 'cinque-cento work' (16th-century). He notes that the subject 'has been frequently repeated [as discussed above, cf Raspe-Tassie], with some slight variations, and it has been explained as representing Venus obtaining from Vulcan armour for Aeneas'. Way describes the ingenious conflation of the word 'Acathe' [sic] (agate) and 'Achates' (Aeneas' loyal companion in the *Aeneid*) in the vellum manuscript, and proposes that the present gem was presented to Queen Elizabeth I by Archbishop Parker (her loyal 'Achates') within the rose turned ivory pyx (lot 3).

Way's argument for the present intaglio being the 'Parker Jewel' would have been given weight by the long association between gem, manuscript and ivory box within the Lloyd Baker family. However, his claim is undermined by the erotic subject matter of the present intaglio, which Way himself describes as 'inappropriate ... as a token of the homage of a grave and pious prelate to his sovereign'.

More significantly, the recent publication of a translation of Matthew Parker's *De Antiquitate Britanniae Ecclesia* in 2014 has revealed that the manuscript likely originally accompanied a golden salt cellar inset with agates presented by Matthew Parker on a royal visit to Canterbury on the occasion of the Queen's 40th birthday (7 September 1573). The text reads:

“Besides this splendid and sumptuous banquet, the Archbishop bestowed certain distinguished gifts upon the Queen, namely a salt cellar made of gold, into the cover of which was inset a jewel, an agate, containing St George killing the dragon, along with verses in French upon the customary royal insignia; in the curved section or hollow of this was enclosed another agate, incised into which was a true likeness of the Queen on white agate. On the top of its cover, a small golden boat held a rectangular diamond. The Archbishop gave the Queen this salt cellar as a gift...”

The manuscript includes illustrations of engraved gems depicting St George and the dragon, and Queen Elizabeth; matching the primary source account quoted above. It is therefore clear that Way was mistaken when he associated the present gem with the Parker manuscript.

DR JOHN SHARP, ARCHBISHOP OF YORK (1644-1714)

The intaglio, manuscript and ivory box (lots 2 and 3) were possibly acquired by Dr John Sharp, Archbishop of York (1644-1714), who was close to Queen Anne (1665-1714). Sharp was a distinguished numismatist and collector of coins and medals, principally of the British Isles. Between 1698 and 1699 he wrote 'Observations on the Coinage of England with a letter to Mr [Ralph] Thoresby' which was eventually published in 1785. An extensive part of his collection was dedicated to coins minted during the reign of Queen Elizabeth I. Archbishop Sharp's collection descended to Catherine Sharp (1770-1843) of Clare Hall, near Barnet, and then to her nephew Thomas Barwick Lloyd Baker (1807-1886), who Albert Way records as the owner of the present intaglio in 1862. Lloyd Baker was a direct descendent of Archbishop Sharp through his maternal grandfather William Sharp (1729-1810), surgeon to King George III.



ARCHBISHOP PARKER'S GIFT



PROPERTY FROM A PRIVATE BRITISH COLLECTION, LOTS 1 – 15

ARCHBISHOP MATTHEW PARKER

PRESENTATION MANUSCRIPT FOR QUEEN ELIZABETH

in the form of nine conjoined vellum roundels (each c. 40mm diameter) in three rows, linked by thin strips of vellum (total size 127 x 127mm), the middle centre roundel illuminated in blue and gold with a finely illustrated St George and the Dragon on a dark blue background surrounded by a Garter with motto, and with surrounding Latin text on the presentation of an agate jewel by Archbishop Matthew Parker to Queen Elizabeth I ("Regni axos Elizabetha gerit Mattheus Achaten Cantuar. Ei donat fidus dum vivet Achates"), the bottom centre roundel with a small miniature portrait of Queen Elizabeth in blue, surrounded by three Latin sententiae, the top row with a definition of agate in French derived from Pliny with headings in gold ink, the remaining roundels with Latin texts on the properties of agate and related subjects derived from Pliny and other Classical sources, the texts in three fine calligraphic hands, [September 1573], mounted on a square of velvet covered board, with a printed exhibition label ("Tudor Exhibition, London. 1889-90. Reg. No 49") on the reverse

PROVENANCE

Archbishop Matthew Parker (1504-1575); by whom gifted to Elizabeth I (1533-1603); possibly acquired John Sharp, Archbishop of York (1645-1714); thence by family descent, certainly to Thomas Barwick Lloyd Baker (1807-1886); thence by family descent to the present owners.

EXHIBITED

London, Tudor Exhibition. 1889-90 Reg. No 49
London, Victoria and Albert Museum, on long-term loan

£ 5,000-10,000

A BIRTHDAY GIFT FOR QUEEN ELIZABETH I FROM HER ARCHBISHOP OF CANTERBURY.

This manuscript is an exceptionally rare relic of the summer progresses that were such a distinctive feature of the pageantry of Queen Elizabeth's reign. On 7 September, her 40th birthday, the Queen was in Canterbury as part of her progress through Kent, where she was invited to a lavish banquet at the Archbishop's Palace. Her host was Archbishop Matthew Parker (1504-1575), a principal architect of the Elizabethan church settlement and the greatest collector of Medieval manuscripts of his generation, and the assembled guests - including the great nobles of the court as well as the French ambassador with a retinue of 100 gentlemen - filled the hall. Archbishop Parker also presented his Queen with a particularly magnificent gift, lovingly described in his own account of proceedings:

"a salt cellar made of gold, into the cover of which was inset a jewel, an agate, containing St George killing the dragon, along with verses in French upon the customary royal insignia; in the curved section or hollow of this was enclosed another agate, incised into which was a true likeness of the Queen on white agate. On the top of its cover, a small golden boat held a rectangular diamond." (Matthew Parker, annotated copy of *De Antiquitate Britanniae Ecclesia*, trans. in *John Nichols's The Progresses and Public Processions of Queen Elizabeth I: A New Edition of the Early Modern Sources* (2014))

The salt incorporated exactly the same agates as are illustrated in this manuscript, and indeed this manuscript is presumably the "verses in French" that were inset into its cover. The unusual shape of this manuscript strongly suggests that it was originally folded to create a single disc of just over 40mm diameter. Although it was probably incorporated into the long-lost salt, the manuscript has long been associated with a turned ivory box (lot 3) into which it could have been fitted, and which may also have formed part of this magnificent gift to the Queen. The manuscript has historically been associated with an intaglio of Venus at the Forge of Vulcan (lot 1) but the identification of that intaglio with Matthew Parker's gift to Queen Elizabeth I is almost certainly mistaken (see Albert Way, 'Notice of a Jeweled Ornament Presented to Queen Elizabeth by Matthew Parker, Archbishop of Canterbury', *The Archaeological Journal*, vol 19 (1862), 145-58).

The manuscript itself is typical of gifts to the Queen. The use of multiple languages is a compliment to her linguistic abilities, whilst the Classical pun on *Achates* - both the Latin for agate and the name of Aeneas's most faithful friend - and references to Pliny are acknowledgements of her learning. The use of different calligraphic scripts for different languages is found in other manuscripts presented to the Queen on progresses or as New Year gifts.

3

THE ROSE BOX



PROPERTY FROM A PRIVATE BRITISH COLLECTION, LOTS 1 – 15

**ENGLISH OR POSSIBLY GERMAN,
SECOND HALF 16TH CENTURY**

ROSE TURNED CIRCULAR BOX

turned ivory
with an old paper label inscribed: "TUDOR EXHIBITION,
LONDON. 1889-90. Reg. No. 49. Cat. No. ..."
3.5 by 5.2cm., 1⅜ by 2in.

PROVENANCE

By tradition Archbishop Matthew Parker (1504-1575);
by whom gifted to Queen Elizabeth I of England (1533-1603)
[as described by Albert Way, 'Notice of a Jeweled Ornament
presented to Queen Elizabeth by Matthew Parker, Archbishop
of Canterbury', *Archaeological Journal*, 19, 1862, pp. 145-158];
possibly acquired John Sharp, Archbishop of York (1645-1714);
thence by family descent
certainly by family descent to Thomas Barwick Lloyd Baker
(1807-1886);
thence by family descent to the present owners

EXHIBITED

London, Tudor Exhibition, 1898-1899;
London, Victoria and Albert Museum, on long term loan
(ref: LOAN:MET ANON.107-1968)

LITERATURE

A. Way, 'Notice of a Jeweled Ornament presented to Queen
Elizabeth by Matthew Parker, Archbishop of Canterbury',
Archaeological Journal, 19, 1862, pp. 145-158;
J. Ferguson and R. Davies, 'A Survey of Tudor and Early
Jacobean Rose Turning', *The Society of Ornamental Turners*,
Bulletin no. 83, p. 141

RELATED LITERATURE

M. Trusted, *Baroque & Later Ivories*, London, 2013

• £ 3,000-5,000

